

Defining a UX Research Point of View (POV)

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Abstract

A User Experience Research Point of View (UXR PoV) is a perspective based on data, evidence, and insight that shapes how you observe, interpret, and represent the needs of your target users. We need to equip UX Practitioners with the essential tools needed to develop and articulate a persuasive PoV. Our mission is to support professionals in preparing and establishing a compelling narrative that aligns with the needs of their stakeholders. We are developing a UXR playbook that defines a set of plays and instructions for practitioners to build, establish, and land a compelling UX Research POV. The proposed workshop offers an opportunity to hear from HCI Researchers, UX Research professionals and cross-functional partners involved in design processes to extend the foundations already laid and create a more detailed UXR POV playbook.

CCS Concepts

• Human-centered computing; • Human computer interaction (HCI); • HCI theory, concepts and models;

Keywords

User Experience Research, Points of View, Playbook, Insight Generation

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1 Motivation

A User Experience Research (UXR) Point of View (POV) [1] is a perspective based on data, evidence, and insight that shapes how you observe, interpret, and represent the needs of your target users. It is built on a foundation of knowledge, research practices, and

insights into a specific domain or business problem. A POV can help to ensure that user desires, needs, preferences, behaviors, and pain points are prioritized throughout the product development process, guiding practitioners in making informed decisions. The UXR Playbook [2], introduced at CHI 2024 [1], provides a set of criteria, standards, and tools to guide research practitioners in forming and communicating compelling POVs that ultimately drive impact.

Several publications have alluded to the need for a POV in UX. For example, Dix et al. [3] state that we need tools to encourage design in context and look towards next-generation design tools that are not simply replete with features but actively support best practices. Similarly, Carter et al. [4] state that we need to explore new paradigms in UX tools, methods, approaches and rethink what “user experience” means when the devices we own are becoming ‘aware’ of their surroundings, context, and have increasing agency. With the advances in Artificial Intelligence (AI) and connected devices and services, there is a demand for extending the scope of existing user experience design tools. Wiberg and Churchill [5], in the 2024 July-August ACM Interactions, mention the critical role that UX can play in the development of responsible AI. They emphasise that systems are becoming increasingly AI-driven, and UX engagement needs to provide a means whereby users can engage directly with the underlying AI components. This suggests that practitioners need to take a holistic approach regardless of technological trends and constraints, emphasising the importance of building a Point of View that considers the full user and system contexts.

Dogan and Giff [6] critically discuss the future of User Experience research across the tech industry and hence the shift from classic usability research towards design-led approaches, quantitative research discipline, A/B testing and telemetry. However, they argue that UX research lacks a method to help researchers and practitioners to form a compelling PoV that drives impact through evidence-based resources, including best practices.

The authors of the UXR POV Playbook have organised multiple workshops across academia and industry to identify and define the POV Framework and identify Use Cases, Plays, and Play Cards. The goal was to expand participation and contributions, increase the number and variety of plays, and build a rich resource that can be utilised by industry practitioners and academic institutions.

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1.1 Objectives

The proposed workshop offers an opportunity to hear from HCI Researchers, UX Research professionals and cross-functional partners involved in design processes to extend the foundations already laid and create a more detailed UXR POV playbook. Additionally, the workshop provides an opportunity to discuss current and future UXR practice with organised exercises, define approaches to developing a UXR POV, and address current challenges to defining future strategies. The envisioned playbook will support UXR upskilling as a UXR resource hub and design toolkit within academia, industry and government services. This will be hosted at <https://www.uxrpovplaybook.com/> and maintained with inputs from existing academic and industrial partners.

The hub is intended to guide practitioners in preparing and establishing persuasive UXR perspectives that drive impactful decision-making within organisations. The ultimate goal is to build a robust platform of case studies, plays, and cards.

2 Organisers

Huseyin Dogan: Bournemouth University. Huseyin Dogan is a Professor of Human Computer Interaction at Bournemouth University, UK. He was the General Co-Chair for the 30th International British Computer Society Human Computer Interaction Conference. His research on Accessibility and Assistive Technology has been featured on the BBC South and BBC Radio Solent. Prior to Bournemouth University, he worked as a Research Associate at Loughborough University. He has eight years industrial experience working as a Human Factors Higher Scientist for BAE Systems Advanced Technology Centre. Prof Dogan received his Engineering Doctorate (EngD) in Systems Engineering from Loughborough University, MSc in Human Computer Interaction with Ergonomics from University College London (UCL), and BSc in Computer Science from Queen Mary University of London.

Renée Barsoum: Admiral. Renée Barsoum is a forward-thinking research leader dedicated to empowering cross-functional teams by bridging the gap between users and product development. With a keen interest in fostering innovation through customer-centricity, she is on a mission to strategically elevate User Experience Research (UXR) practices across various industries. Currently employed at the Admiral Group, Renée brings valuable experience from previous roles at OcadoTechnology, Pitney Bowes, and Rightmove.

Stephen Giff: Google. Stephen is UX Research Strategist and Manager. He has led UX teams at Microsoft and Google and is currently head of data science for the Google Cloud Business Platform Team. Stephen has a passion for evolving the UX Research discipline and has participated in numerous events evangelising the importance of establishing and communicating POV's. Originally hailing from London, UK he now lives in Seattle, US. He has a Degree in Psychology from Birkbeck, University of London, and a Masters in HCI from UCL.

Alan Dix: Swansea University & Cardiff Metropolitan University. Alan Dix is a Professorial Fellow at Cardiff Metropolitan University and Professor Emeritus at Swansea University. He is also a Member of the ACM CHI Academy and Fellow of the Learned Society of Wales. He is known for his extensive research in HCI

and co-authored HCI text book. His other works include TouchIT on the confluence of physical and digital design, and a small AI textbook, which has grown considerably with a second edition due in 2025. Recent work as part of the InContext project has looked at the requirements for next generation UX design tools.

Elizabeth Churchill: Mohamed Bin Zayed University of Artificial Intelligence. Elizabeth Churchill is Department Chair and Professor of Human Computer Interaction at MBZUAI (Mohamed Bin Zayed University of Artificial Intelligence). She was formerly a Senior Director of User Experience at Google. She is a member of the ACM's CHI Academy, and is an ACM Fellow and Distinguished Speaker. She has built research teams at Google, eBay, Yahoo, PARC and FujiXerox. She holds a PhD from the University of Cambridge and honorary doctorates from Stockholm University and the University of Sussex. She has received numerous awards including the 2016 Citris-Banatao Institute Award Athena Award for Women in Technology for her Executive Leadership, the 2023 the ACM SIGCHI Lifetime Service Award, and the 2024 the ACM SIGCHI Lifetime Practice Award.

3 In-Person or Hybrid

This will be an in-person workshop. However, the opening/keynote speakers will be given a chance to present remotely, if they are unable to attend.

4 Workshop

This in-person workshop will aim to develop a series Use Cases, Plays, and Play Cards that will be used to extend the UXR POV playbook.

4.1 Pre-workshop activities

Call for participation from academia and industry to propose use cases and plays, authors will be able to opt-in for a further exploration of their case study during the workshop. These submissions will be used in the workshop breakout sessions.

4.2 Workshop activities and schedule

Part 1:

09:00 - 09:15 | Welcome and introductions

09:15 - 09:30 | Organisers intro: the importance of UXR's establishing clear POV's

09:30 - 10:10 | Keynote speaker in-person / recorded

10:10 - 11:00 | Participant presentations (10 short pre-selected presentations 5 mins each)

11:00 - 11:20 | Break

Part 2:

11:20 - 12:00 | Workshop activity intro, set-up and break-out

12:00 - 13:00 | Lunch break

13:00 - 15:00 | Workshop Activity in break-out groups (selected case study papers)

15:00 - 15:20 | Break

15:20 - 16:20 | Sharing the breakout group artefacts

16:20 - 16:30 | Closing notes

4.3 Workshop description

This in-person workshop will be divided into two main parts:

- Part one aims to inspire creativity and expand participants' perspectives on User Experience Research (UXR). It will include an introduction to the workshop's objectives, keynote, paper presentations by academic and industry leaders discussing UXR success stories and latest industry trends.
- In part two, participants will be divided into three subgroups and assigned a preselected use case. Each subgroup will be facilitated by one of the workshop organisers. The group will then analyse the use case, carefully examining it to identify the key challenges, opportunities, and potential impact [7]. Note that organisers will work directly with the authors of selected papers before the session to identify key questions that will be used to generate the breakout activities, preparing them to move through the four stages of building a Point of View: Foundation » Data » Insight Generation » POV.
- If the number of participants in each subgroup exceeds 15, they will be split into different tables, each covering one or more POV building stages.

Participants will then apply the UXR POV framework, mapping the selected use case, and identifying the appropriate strategies. Based on their analysis and application of the framework, the breakout group will brainstorm and develop specific strategies and tactics that can be used to achieve an impactful UXR POV. They will use a template to create visual representations of their strategies and tactics in the form of cards.

Once all breakout groups have completed their work, they will share their findings and cards with the rest of the workshop participants, fostering collaboration and learning.

4.4 Post-Workshop Plans

- Publish use cases, plays, and play cards to UXR POV Playbook Website already developed by the organizing team - <https://www.uxrpovplaybook.com/>.
- Publish Workshop Proceedings via ArXiv.
- Publish an article sharing plays and extending requests for additional plays in ACM Interactions Magazine, or similar.
- Write an article for The Conversation, a media outlet publishing articles written by academics and researchers. This will summarize the outcomes of the workshop.

5 Call for Participation

A User Experience Research Point of View (UXR PoV) is a perspective based on data, evidence, and insight that shapes how you observe, interpret, and represent the needs of your target users. We need to equip UX Practitioners with the essential tools needed to develop and articulate a persuasive PoV. Our mission is to support professionals in preparing and establishing a compelling narrative that aligns with the needs of their stakeholders. We are developing a UXR playbook that defines a set of plays and instructions for practitioners to build, establish, and land a compelling UX Research POV.

Authors are invited to submit a paper to the CHI Workshop on "The Power of POV: Transforming UXR Insights into Actionable Strategies and Meaningful Impact" to further develop the initial UXR PoV playbook. We are interested in UX case studies, plays, and

best practices that can be embedded into the playbook. Selected papers will be used as exemplar case studies during the workshop.

- Primary submission: consists of an extended abstract in the ACM Master Article Submission Templates (single column; 4-8 pages, excluding references).
- Secondary submission: submit a one-page statement of interest for consideration, including interest/related experience, and anticipated contributions.
- Submissions by email (.docx or .pdf format) to hdogan@bournemouth.ac.uk, sgiff@google.com.

The workshop proceedings will be published via ArXiv. At least one author of each accepted submission must attend the workshop. Participants must register for both the workshop and for at least one day of the conference.

Workshop website: <https://www.uxrpovplaybook.com/chi2025workshop>

6 Expected Size of Attendance

We expect 35-50 participants to attend this workshop.

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